

# Was it happening?

Uma extensao da deducao no passado: em vez de "aconteceu e terminou", as vezes voce quer dizer "estava acontecendo naquele momento". Para isso, o ingles usa modal + have been + verbo-ing.

TEXTO ADAPTADO NIVEL B1+

EXTRA - COMPLEMENTA A AULA DE DEDUCAO

ganbare - you've got this

## 01 The Room Above Mine

Leitura - By Yuki Tanaka

Something above my room kept making noise all night. Feet moving. A chair scraping<sup>1</sup>. A door closing softly. It was 2am. Someone up there **must have been walking** around, back and forth, unable to sleep either.

In the morning, I asked the front desk about it. The receptionist looked confused<sup>2</sup>. "That room is empty," she said. "No one has stayed there this week." The noise **can't have been coming** from the hallway either. I could hear it directly above me, not beside me.

I thought about it on the train home. It **might have been** the pipes, settling<sup>3</sup> as the building cooled down. Or the sound **might have been coming** from a completely different room, one floor away, echoing<sup>4</sup> strangely through the old walls. I'll never know for certain<sup>5</sup>. But something, somewhere, **must have been happening**.

### NOTAS DE LEITURA - GLOSSARIO

1. **scraping**: making a rough sound by dragging something along a surface (*arrastando, raspando*; こすれる音を立てる)
2. **confused**: not understanding what is happening (*confuso(a)*; 困惑した)
3. **settling**: a building slowly shifting or making small noises as it cools or ages (*acomodando-se, assentando*; (建物が) 落ち着く)
4. **echoing**: a sound repeating or bouncing off walls (*ecoando*; 響く)
5. **certain**: completely sure about something (*certo, seguro*; 確実な)

~95%

**must have been + -ing**

Quase certeza de que algo estava em andamento.

*"Someone must have been cooking."*

~50%

**might/could have been + -ing**

Possibilidade de uma ação em progresso no passado.

*"She might have been sleeping."*

~50%

**may have been + -ing**

Igual a might have been, mais formal.

*"They may have been waiting."*

~95%

**can't have been + -ing**

Praticamente impossível que a ação estivesse ocorrendo.

*"He can't have been driving that fast."*

**A ideia central:** a forma simples ("must have missed") descreve uma ação completa. A forma continua descreve uma ação em progresso num momento específico do passado. Mesma lógica do Present Continuous vs. Present Simple, aplicada a dedução.

| CONTEXTO                                   | SIMPLES (AÇÃO COMPLETA)                   | CONTINUA (EM ANDAMENTO)                                       |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Panelas ainda na cozinha, cheiro de comida | Someone <b>must have cooked</b> dinner.   | Someone <b>must have been cooking</b> when you arrived.       |
| Cabelo molhado, respiração ofegante        | She <b>must have exercised</b> .          | She <b>must have been exercising</b> right before you called. |
| Barreiras tornam a velocidade impossível   | A car <b>can't have driven</b> that fast. | A car <b>can't have been driving</b> that fast here.          |

**COMO ESCOLHER**

Pistas que pedem a forma **continua**: "when I arrived", "at that moment", "still", "for two hours", "on and off". Pistas que pedem a forma **simples**: "already", "by the time", evidência de um resultado finalizado.

**SIMPLES VS. CONTINUA**

You come home and find your roommate's laptop open, a **half-written email on the screen**, and **coffee still warm** beside it.

**She must have been answering emails when something interrupted her.**

**Por que a forma continua:** o e-mail está pela metade e o café ainda está quente. As evidências apontam para uma ação interrompida, não já concluída.

### IMPOSSIBILIDADE CONTINUA

Your friend says he was watching TV all evening, but **the remote's batteries died three days ago and were never replaced.**

**He can't have been watching TV all evening. There's no way to turn it on.**

Por que "can't have been watching": a evidencia (pilhas mortas) torna fisicamente impossivel a acao continua alegada.

## 03 Practice

Simples ou continua?

### 03.01

You knock on the bathroom door, and you can hear water running behind it.

She \_\_\_\_\_ a shower. (*take*)

### 03.02

Your neighbour's music was loud, on and off, for nearly two hours after midnight.

They \_\_\_\_\_ a party. (*have*)

### 03.03

The car's engine was still warm, but it was parked perfectly and every door was locked.

Someone \_\_\_\_\_ it recently. (*drive*)

### 03.04

The photocopier felt warm and a stack of fresh pages sat uncollected on the tray when you walked in.

Someone \_\_\_\_\_ it just moments before you arrived. (*use*)

### 03.05

The trail was covered in fresh, clear footprints, though no one else was in sight.

Someone \_\_\_\_\_ this trail earlier. (*walk*)

### 03.06

The shop's power was cut for the entire night, confirmed by the electric company, yet a witness swears the lights were on at 2am.

Staff \_\_\_\_\_ there at 2am. It's simply not possible. (*work*)

**03.07**

Your sister says she spent the whole afternoon reading, but the bookmark is still on page one and the book looks untouched.

She \_\_\_\_\_ all afternoon. The book hasn't moved. (*read*)

**03.08**

You open the oven and find a perfectly baked, fully cooled cake sitting on the rack.

Someone \_\_\_\_\_ this hours ago. (*bake*)

**04 Quick Patterns**

Perguntando sobre acoes em andamento

**Yes/No**

"Could he have been sleeping when you knocked?"

**Wh-question**

"What could they have been doing all that time?"

**Short answer**

"He must have been, yes." / "She can't have been. She was with me."

**05 Speaking Corner****DISCUSSION**

- Think of a strange noise or unexplained moment from a trip. What do you think must have been happening, and why?
- Compare: "He must have left" vs. "He must have been leaving." What's the difference in meaning?
- Describe a moment you walked into a room and could tell something had just been happening there, before you arrived.

## Answer Key - Gabarito

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- 03.01: must have been taking  
03.02: must have been having  
03.03: must have driven  
03.04: must have been using  
03.05: must have walked  
03.06: can't have been working  
03.07: can't have been reading  
03.08: must have baked